

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 698

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate the officers and members of the new American Legion Post in Signal Mountain.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause in their deliberations to pay tribute to those exemplary organizations and their members who give unselfishly of themselves, their time, and their talents to perpetuate the public good; and

WHEREAS, recently receiving its organizational charter, the newly formed Captain Larry L. Taylor American Legion Post 293 in Signal Mountain is most assuredly one such extraordinary group deserving of praise and commendation; and

WHEREAS, the American Legion was established on March 15, 1919, at the American Club in Paris, France, by members of the American Expeditionary Force who served there during World War I; and

WHEREAS, the American Legion was chartered by the United States Congress on September 16, 1919, as a patriotic veterans organization devoted to mutual helpfulness; and

WHEREAS, today, as the nation's largest wartime veterans service organization, the American Legion brings together a global network of some 1.6 million members and more than 12,000 posts throughout all fifty states, the District of Columbia, Puerto Rico, France, Latin America, and the Philippines; and

WHEREAS, throughout its storied history, the American Legion has worked to better the lives of veterans and their families. In 1921, the Legion's efforts led to the creation of the U.S. Veterans Bureau, the forerunner of the Department of Veterans Affairs, and during World War II, it successfully won passage of its greatest legislative achievement, the Servicemen's Readjustment Act of 1944, better known as the GI Bill; and

WHEREAS, the newly chartered American Legion Post 293 in Signal Mountain is named in honor of Captain Larry L. Taylor, a recent Medal of Honor recipient, a true American hero, and a proud resident of Signal Mountain; and

WHEREAS, on April 17, 2025, Captain Larry L. Taylor American Legion Post 293 held its inaugural organizational meeting, during which officers were appointed and the organizational charter was received; present at the meeting were the newly installed officers: Post Commander Andrew Flor, Adjutant Lacey Hoover, Vice Commander Larry Phipps, Finance Officer Chad Mobley, and Chaplain Richard Baldwin; and

WHEREAS, Legionnaires are proud of their organization and its constant vigilance to uphold the core values of our nation—liberty, justice, respect, and equality; and

WHEREAS, Legion members have remained true to their founders' vision of a long-standing commitment to America's veterans, a vision that is consistent with the first rule of battle, "We will not fail those with whom we serve"; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor the esteemed members of the newly formed American Legion Post in Signal Mountain; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we congratulate the officers and members of the Captain Larry L. Taylor American Legion Post 293 in Signal Mountain upon their recent formation and commend their meritorious service to the United States as we extend our best wishes for continued success in all their endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.